New Winners at the New York City Marathon

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Andreas Almgren from Sweden won the men's race at the New York City Marathon on Sunday. It was his first time running a full marathon, which is 26.2 miles long. He had run shorter **half-marathons** before. He **pulled ahead** of Yemaneberhan Crippa from Italy in the last mile and won in 2 hours, 6 minutes and 1 second. Crippa finished 13 seconds later. Kamohelo Mofolo from Lesotho came third, just ahead of last year's winner, Benson Kipruto. Almgren's time was the third fastest ever on this **course**.

Sheila Chepkirui from Kenya won the women's race for the second time. She ran past Hellen Obiri near the end and won in 2 hours, 24 minutes and 36 seconds. Jessica McClain from the United States finished second, six seconds behind. She was the first American woman in the **top three** since 2018.

About 60,000 runners from more than 140 countries took part. The race went through all five parts of New York City, called **boroughs**. It started in 1970 in Central Park. This year the **course** changed a little at Mile 20.

Word Treasure

half-marathons -- A race that is half the length of a full marathon.
boroughs -- The five parts that make up New York City.
course -- The path a race follows.
pulled ahead -- To move ahead of another runner.
top three -- The first three finishers in a race.

Background you need

A marathon is a very long running race.

Runners train for months to run the whole distance.

The New York City Marathon is one of the biggest marathons in the world, with runners from many countries.

Break it down

WHO: Andreas Almgren and Sheila Chepkirui, the men's and women's winners
WHAT: They won the New York City Marathon races
WHERE: New York City, through all five boroughs
WHY: They ran the fastest times in their races

Why it matters

Training for a long race shows how steady practice can help you reach a big goal.

Test what you remember

1. Who won the men's race?

(A) Yemaneberhan Crippa
(B) Benson Kipruto
(C) Andreas Almgren
(D) Kamohelo Mofolo

2. How long is a full marathon?

(A) 26.2 miles
(B) 60,000 runners
(C) 13 seconds
(D) 140 countries

3. Who won the women's race?

(A) Jessica McClain
(B) Andreas Almgren
(C) Sheila Chepkirui
(D) Hellen Obiri

4. About how many runners took part?

(A) About 60,000
(B) 140
(C) Five
(D) 1970

5. Where did the race start in 1970?

(A) Lesotho
(B) Sweden
(C) Mile 20
(D) Central Park

6. Who was the first American woman in the top three since 2018?

(A) Jessica McClain
(B) Sheila Chepkirui
(C) Andreas Almgren
(D) Hellen Obiri

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: C 4: A 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):